# Accounts, identity, Regions and costs

INSTRUCTOR ANSWERS - STAFF ONLY

## Core questions 1-5

Use groups of five at suitable points in the session. Ask learners to explain their choice and one rejected option. Use the final five if helpful. Keep these group discussions separate from the existing individual knowledge-check scores.

### 1. An employer gives a learner a role in a shared training account instead of a separate account. Which statement about the resources that the learner creates is correct?

**Correct answer: C. They belong to the shared account, which records their charges, so the owner tag shows whose they are.**

Every resource belongs to one account, and AWS bills that account for its use. A role is an identity that acts in the account; it doesn't own resources or receive charges. In a shared account, other learners' resources carry the same course tag, so the owner tag is how a learner finds their own.

### 2. A learner's employer can't provide AWS access for the course. What does the course expect the learner to do?

**Correct answer: B. Arrange a personal AWS account that meets the course requirements by the start of Week 2.**

Learners arrange their own AWS access, through their employer or a personal account, by the start of Week 2. A Builder ID sounds like AWS access, but it signs you in to Skill Builder and AWS training sites; it isn't an AWS account and can't call AWS services. The instructor's demonstration account isn't shared with learners.

### 3. Exercise 2 opens on Day 3, and a learner's AWS access will be ready at the start of Week 2. What can the learner do with Exercise 2 before then?

**Correct answer: C. The learner can complete its functions and run its check, then run the AWS cells later.**

An exercise's functions and its check run without an AWS account; only the cells that call AWS need the learner's own access. The package doesn't replace live calls with recordings, so those cells wait for the account. Sharing the instructor's credentials would break the rule that each request has the caller's own identity.

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**4. During the demonstration, two invented credentials are set for one command, and the command fails with InvalidClientTokenId. What does this failure establish?**

**Correct answer: B. AWS couldn't authenticate the credentials, so it rejected the request before evaluating any policy.**

InvalidClientTokenId means that AWS doesn't recognise the credentials, which is a failure of authentication. IAM reads policies only for an identity that it has authenticated, so neither an implicit nor an explicit denial has happened yet. An authorisation failure returns an access-denied error that names the principal and the action instead.

**5. A cloud team attaches a permissions boundary that allows bedrock:* to a learner's role. No identity-based policy on the role mentions guardrails. What happens when the role lists guardrails in London?**

**Correct answer: D. The call fails with an implicit denial, because a boundary only limits permissions and grants nothing.**

A permissions boundary sets the most that identity-based policies can grant, and it grants nothing by itself. No identity-based policy allows bedrock:ListGuardrails, so IAM denies the call by default. The denial is implicit, not explicit, because no Deny statement matches the request.

Discussion: Ask the group to connect one of these ideas to today's Kestrel example. Use the Day 1 learner handbook to resolve uncertainty.

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## Core questions 6-10

### 6. Why does the course prefer IAM Identity Center to an access key for a learner's own IAM user?

**Correct answer: B. With Identity Center, the AWS CLI holds only short-term credentials, which it refreshes for the learner.**

Identity Center gives the CLI temporary credentials for a role session, which expire and are refreshed, so no long-term key sits on the laptop. The session's role still carries the learner's policies, so it isn't exempt from them. An IAM user's access key remains the fallback when an employer has no Identity Center, and it can call Bedrock if its policies allow.

### 7. A learner sets AWS_PROFILE=fde, which names their Identity Center profile, but aws sts get-caller-identity shows an IAM user from another project. What is the most likely cause?

**Correct answer: C. Access key variables from the other project are still set, and the CLI uses them before the profile.**

The AWS CLI uses the first credentials that its provider chain finds, and environment variables such as AWS_ACCESS_KEY_ID come before the profile's Identity Center settings. An expired session makes the CLI ask the learner to sign in again; it doesn't switch to another profile. Unsetting the two access key variables lets the fde profile sign the next request.

### 8. An engineer runs aws sts get-caller-identity before changing a resource in a client's account. What does a successful result confirm?

**Correct answer: B. It confirms the account and principal that signed the request, but not what they may do.**

The call returns the account, the ARN and the user ID of the identity that signed the request, and it needs no permission at all. It therefore proves nothing about what that identity may do. The engineer still checks the Region separately, because the response doesn't report it.

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**9. A learner wants to share an access-denied message with a partner. Which change does the course ask for before the learner shares it?**

**Correct answer: D. Replace the 12-digit account number with <account-id>, and leave out the UserId field.**

An access-denied message contains the account number, which a partner doesn't need, so the course replaces it with <account-id>. The action and the reason are what make the message useful for diagnosis, so they stay. A role name isn't a credential, although a session name that contains an email address can also be replaced with <session-name>.

**10. A learner's profile sets region = us-east-1, AWS_DEFAULT_REGION is eu-west-2, AWS_REGION isn't set, and the command has no --region option. Which Region receives the request?**

**Correct answer: A. It goes to London, because AWS_DEFAULT_REGION comes before the profile's region setting.**

The AWS CLI takes the Region from --region, then AWS_REGION, then AWS_DEFAULT_REGION, and finally the profile's region setting, and it uses the first value that it finds. aws configure get region reads only the profile's setting, so here it returns us-east-1 even though the request goes to London. The CLI stops with the error only when no source supplies a Region.

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## Core questions 11-15

### 11. Kestrel asks how the assistant keeps its data in the United Kingdom. Which statement is accurate?

**Correct answer: A. Resources are created in London, but model calls through the EU profile can run in other European Regions.**

The choice of Region decides where Kestrel's resources and data are stored, and the course creates them in London. Calls through the EU profile can run in any of the profile's European destination Regions, so prompts and responses can leave London while staying in Europe. Availability Zones improve availability within a Region; they don't change where the data is.

### 12. A role has one policy that allows budgets:ViewBudget and another, the learner policy, with a Deny statement for budgets:*. What is the result of a request to view a budget?

**Correct answer: D. It's explicitly denied, because a matching Deny statement overrides any allow.**

IAM checks for a matching Deny statement first, and no allow can override it, however specific the allow is. The order in which policies were attached plays no part in evaluation. The access-denied message reports an explicit deny in an identity-based policy.

### 13. An organisation adds a policy that denies every action where aws:RequestedRegion isn't eu-west-2. Shortly afterwards, calls such as iam:GetRole start to fail. Why?

**Correct answer: D. IAM has a single endpoint in N. Virginia, so its calls carry us-east-1 and match the deny.**

A few global services, such as IAM, have one endpoint in N. Virginia, so their requests carry us-east-1 as the requested Region. A policy that denies every Region except one must therefore exempt the global services. IAM calls do carry a Region value, so the claim that they carry none is wrong.

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**14. Two learners run the same command in their own employer accounts. One succeeds and the other receives an access-denied error. What is the most likely explanation?**

**Correct answer: B. Their accounts apply different policies, because the supplied learner policy is only an example.**

Each employer's account applies its owner's policies, and the supplied learner policy is a teaching example, not a requirement that AWS enforces. The laptop check runs on the learner's machine and has no effect on AWS decisions. Throttling returns ThrottlingException, not an access-denied error.

**15. Kestrel's auditor wants to know which Region ran a model call that the assistant sent from London through the EU inference profile. Where does the auditor find it?**

**Correct answer: C. The auditor reads the CloudTrail event in London, where its inferenceRegion field names the Region.**

CloudTrail records every cross-Region call in the source Region, and the event's additionalEventData.inferenceRegion field names the Region that ran the call. The profile names the Regions that can run a call, not the one that did. The account pays the source Region's price, so the bill doesn't identify the destination.

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## Core questions 16-20

### 16. Code in London calls Claude Haiku 4.5 with modelId set to anthropic.claude-haiku-4-5-20251001-v1:0, and Bedrock returns a ValidationException about on-demand throughput. What should the team change?

**Correct answer: A. Pass an inference profile, such as eu.anthropic.claude-haiku-4-5-20251001-v1:0, as the modelId.**

From London, Bedrock supports on-demand calls to Claude Haiku 4.5 only through an inference profile, and the ValidationException asks for one. A missing use-case form returns FTUFormNotFilled, and a missing permission returns an access-denied error, so neither matches this message. Inference profiles don't use Provisioned Throughput.

### 17. A workload reaches its token quota before its request quota. Each request has 4,000 input tokens, max_tokens of 4,000 and about 200 output tokens. Why does lowering max_tokens to 800 let more requests start each minute?

**Correct answer: B. Bedrock deducts the input tokens plus max_tokens when a request starts, so each request holds less quota.**

At the start of a request, Bedrock reserves the input tokens plus max_tokens against the token quota, and it settles the actual figure at the end. A limit far above the expected answer holds quota that the request never uses. Billing counts only the tokens that the model read and wrote, and an answer of 200 tokens is the same length under either limit.

### 18. A new personal account has a forecast alert at 80 per cent of its monthly budget. Why can't the account rely on that alert during its first weeks?

**Correct answer: A. AWS needs about five weeks of usage data before it can forecast, so the alert can't fire yet.**

AWS Budgets needs about five weeks of usage data before it can forecast spending, so a new account relies on actual-spend alerts. The learner policy limits the learner's own requests to Budgets and Cost Explorer; it doesn't stop AWS from evaluating the account's budget. A budget alert can go to up to ten email addresses and one SNS topic.

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**19. A learner wants to check whether the learner policy allows bedrock:ListGuardrails in Ireland without sending a request there. What does aws iam simulate-principal-policy offer, and what is its limit?**

**Correct answer: A. It returns IAM's decision for each action without calling the service, and it may omit some controls.**

The simulator evaluates the policies for the actions and condition values that you give it, and it returns allowed, implicitDeny or explicitDeny. It doesn't send a request to the service and can leave out controls that affect the live account. A suitable real request therefore confirms the result before you rely on it.

**20. Why must a learner's teardown list tagged resources in both London and N. Virginia under the learner policy?**

**Correct answer: C. The policy allows creation in both Regions, and get-resources returns only the Region of the request.**

The learner policy allows course resources in eu-west-2 and us-east-1, and get-resources returns tagged resources only in the Region that receives the request. A resource created in N. Virginia by mistake is therefore invisible to a London listing. Listing again in both Regions after deletion confirms that nothing remains.

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## Optional extra questions 21-25

### 21. A first call to Claude Haiku 4.5 in a new personal account returns FTUFormNotFilled with HTTP status 404. What must happen before the call can succeed?

**Correct answer: D. Someone with suitable permissions must submit Anthropic's use-case details for the account.**

Anthropic asks first-time customers to submit use-case details once per account, or once at the organisation's management account, and until then a call returns FTUFormNotFilled. The Marketplace subscription is a separate step that Bedrock starts on the first call; while it completes, calls can succeed, and a failed subscription returns AccessDeniedException, not this error.

### 22. An organisation wants to stop anyone using a newly listed model until its legal team has reviewed the licence terms. What should the organisation do?

**Correct answer: A. Deny bedrock:InvokeModel and bedrock:InvokeModelWithResponseStream on the model's ARN.**

Denying the invocation actions on the model's ARN stops every call before the first one can accept the licence terms. Denying aws-marketplace:Subscribe alone isn't reliable, because Bedrock starts the subscription itself and calls can succeed while it is set up. The use-case form applies only to Anthropic models, and a budget action reacts only after billing data shows spending.

### 23. During a busy period, a client receives HTTP 503 ServiceUnavailable from Bedrock, although the account's usage is well below its quotas. What does the error indicate?

**Correct answer: D. The service lacked capacity at that moment, which cross-Region inference can help to absorb.**

A 503 or 529 error means that the service lacked capacity at that moment, not that the account exceeded a quota. An exceeded quota returns ThrottlingException with HTTP status 429. Bedrock doesn't queue requests for you, so the client retries with backoff, and a cross-Region profile spreads calls across several Regions.

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### 24. Kestrel's finance team looks in Cost Explorer for the assistant's Claude charges under Amazon Bedrock and finds almost nothing. Where do the charges appear?

**Correct answer: A. They appear under the AWS Marketplace billing entity, by model provider.**

Claude is billed through AWS Marketplace, so its charges appear under the AWS Marketplace billing entity, by model provider, not under Amazon Bedrock. The account pays the source Region's price, whichever destination Region runs the call. To report model costs by application, the team tags an application inference profile and activates the tag key for cost allocation.

### 25. If Kestrel fine-tuned a model on its own support cases, which scope of the Generative AI Security Scoping Matrix would the assistant move to?

**Correct answer: C. It would move to Scope 4, and Kestrel would also own the training data and the custom model.**

Fine-tuning moves the assistant from Scope 3, an application on a pre-trained model, to Scope 4, a fine-tuned model. Kestrel would then also own the training data and the custom model, including anything it learned from customer cases. Scope 5 means training a model from scratch, which fine-tuning a foundation model isn't.

Discussion: Ask the group to connect one of these ideas to today's Kestrel example. Use the Day 1 learner handbook to resolve uncertainty.